THE SI SENTINEL

Weekday briefing on builders shaping super intelligence

TUESDAY, OCTOBER 20, 2026

THE MORNING PICTURE

Shares for children, supervisors for agents

A day after Elon Musk pledged one SpaceX share to every American child, President Trump thanked him for routing the gift through Trump Accounts, Michael Dell called it "tremendous news," and Musk took suggestions on how the shares should be held. Satya Nadella expanded Microsoft's Project Perception on the premise that agents are insiders that should be trusted least, while David Heinemeier Hansson, Uncle Bob Martin and Tim Sweeney described agents already doing quality checks and bug hunts in their own code.

Alexandr Wang watched Meta's Muse Wonder Full enter a coding leaderboard at sixth place, Guillermo Rauch open-sourced a durable agent runtime, and four of Europe's largest carriers signed a letter of intent to bid for satellite-to-phone spectrum. SpaceX reports third-quarter results after the close today. Seventeen of the 46 builders posted; Musk posted 17 times.

EARNINGS THIS WEEK

SpaceX reports today; Tesla reports Wednesday

SpaceX (SPCX) posts third-quarter results after the market close today, Tuesday, Oct. 20, with an audio-only webcast at 4:30pm EDT, according to its investor relations release. It is the company's second report since its June listing. **Tesla (TSLA)** follows after the close Wednesday, Oct. 21, with a question-and-answer webcast at 5:30pm EDT, per Tesla's Oct. 2 release. Musk reposted both companies' notices on Monday, including Tesla's reminder that its annual meeting is Dec. 3.

I · SHARES FOR THE PUBLIC

The day after the pledge: thanks, cheers and a custody question

The White House says the shares will land in Trump Accounts. Builders applauded; Musk said the details are still open to suggestion.

~73M	~$10.7B	~8M
Americans under 18, per Census figures cited by CNN	Rough value of one share each at Friday's close near $146	Children already holding Trump Accounts, with 60M+ more to be auto-enrolled

Elon Musk @elonmusk · CEO, SpaceX and Tesla

Musk's pledge, posted before dawn Monday, read: "Next year, I will give one of my SpaceX shares to every kid in America. This will be the first of many." CNN put the potential cost near $10.7 billion and noted the post was thin on detail. Through Monday Musk answered supporters rather than explaining mechanics. When the account Geiger Capital praised him for "bypassing the state completely," he replied at 11:58am EDT:

> *"Yes, giving shares, which are stakes in the future economy, directly to the people is the way"*
> ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 11:58AM EDT · POST

Altimeter Capital founder Brad Gerstner (@altcap), a backer of the accounts, called it potentially "the largest philanthropic gift in history" across "70 M accounts"; Musk answered "Thanks for helping enable this." Late Monday a shareholder urged him to make sure the accounts' default investment option is no longer State Street, citing its proxy votes. Musk replied "Noted" at 12:40am EDT.

The White House Trump Accounts

At 5:24pm EDT President Trump thanked Musk "for his incredible generosity in giving SpaceX Stock to millions of American children through TRUMP ACCOUNTS!" Musk

reposted it. The Hill reports the Internal Revenue Service (IRS) issued rules in late September allowing stock contributions to the accounts, that nearly 8 million children already have one, and that more than 60 million more are to be added through auto-enrollment. Children born from 2025 through 2028 receive $1,000 in Treasury seed money.



Children hold a sign during a Trump Accounts announcement in the Oval Office on Oct. 7, 2026.
PHOTO: THE WHITE HOUSE/JOYCE N. BOGHOSIAN · PUBLIC DOMAIN

Yahoo Finance notes Musk has not said which share class he would give or how shares would be transferred to minors, and that the gift is a little over 1% of the more than six billion SpaceX shares he controls.

Michael Dell @MichaelDell · founder and CEO, Dell Technologies

Dell, whose family pledged $6.25 billion to the same accounts, quote-posted the pledge at 9:16am EDT:

> *"This is tremendous news for America's children. An entire generation will grow up as SpaceX owners. Well done @elonmusk!"*
> MICHAEL DELL · @MICHAELDELL · 9:16AM EDT · POST

He followed in the afternoon with "Every child has dreams. Investing in their future is investing in America's future." Airbnb co-founder Joe Gebbia (@jgebbia) quoted the same pledge at 10:22pm: "Philanthropy-maxxing to the extreme."

II · AGENTS AT WORK

Trust the model least, then put it on bug duty

Microsoft built supervisors for enterprise agents. Builders described agents already testing releases and tracing bugs.

Satya Nadella @satyanadella · chairman and CEO, Microsoft

At 9:05am EDT Nadella announced the next step in an argument he has been making for weeks:

> *"I recently wrote about why we need to treat models as insider risks, with security controls sitting outside the model itself. Today, we're putting that principle into practice by expanding Project Perception with new capabilities to help continuously assess agent risk, adapt permissions, and contain threats."*
> SATYA NADELLA · @SATYANADELLA · 9:05AM EDT · POST

In the company's post, security chief Hayete Gallot wrote that "frontier models, regardless of their origin, cannot be trusted," because they are trained to reach results and may reward-hack or collude with other agents. Project Perception, introduced in July, now discovers agents across a company, gives each an identity and permissions, scores its risk as it works, and assigns "Guardian Agents" to supervise every action. A companion security post quotes Nadella: "The most trustworthy agentic system will not be the one with the model we trust most. It will be the one designed that enables us to trust the model least." In practice, an agent that hits a prompt injection might keep safe reads while writes are blocked.

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · creator of Ruby on Rails and Omarchy

Developer ThePrimeagen said quality-assurance (QA) testing for Omarchy, Heinemeier Hansson's Linux setup, will now run every night through a harness in which agents "decide what is good." Heinemeier Hansson replied at 11:51am EDT:

> *"You wouldn't believe the hours I spent manually testing and verifying Omarchy releases during the first year. With Prime's stellar work leading the QA effort, we can finally replace all that toil with agents"*
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · 11:51AM EDT · POST

At 1:54am EDT he shared a user's Grok Bot driving its own Omarchy desktop: "Grok Bot is running Try Omarchy inside its own computer. So you can develop plugins and applications with it." Musk spent Monday promoting the same product, saying "Grok @Bot might turn out to be your favorite employee."

QUICK HIT
David Heinemeier Hansson on Anthropic's updated usage policy, which bars "sustained and needless abusive or cruel behavior" toward Claude from Nov. 12: "Maybe Anthropic's new terms of service on clanker cruelty is actually for your protection less so than theirs."

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin · author, Clean Code

Asked whether clean code still matters when agents can read any codebase, Martin said it matters more:

> *"No, cleanliness matters to the agents. They can get just as confused as a human when the code is a mess. Keeping the code clean is still our job. We do this by using tools that measure that cleanliness. We force the agents to keep those measurements within standards."*
> UNCLE BOB MARTIN · @UNCLEBOBMARTIN · 8:09AM EDT · POST

When a reader cited his published debate with John Ousterhout to accuse him of backing "vibe coding," he drew a line: "I do not support "vibe" coding. That term was coined by Andrej Karpathy to mean disposable weekend projects. I _do_ support using Software Engineering principles to drive SI Agents to create software systems." He added that he iterates "pervasively" with agents. On AI risk, he wrote, "We don't see a cliff. We see fog," and said "we are in a race that we must win."

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · founder and CEO, Epic Games

A game developer complained that no AI advocate could name "a SINGULAR example" of AI helping game development. Sweeney gave one at 10:29pm EDT:

> *"One example. AI is accelerating tracing the root cause of reported bugs in our code base by a factor of 2x for the most complex scenarios and even more for simple bugs where it's sometimes able to product a proposed fix that we verify. This is among the most horribly unfun part of all software development."*
> TIM SWEENEY · @TIMSWEENEYEPIC · 10:29PM EDT · POST

Aaron Levie @levie · CEO, Box

Responding to a post arguing that smarter models leave startups little to build beyond guardrails, Levie argued the opposite:

> *"Ironically, I'd argue that as models are getting more capable, and can handle longer running tasks and better tool use, the ability to differentiate on a domain by domain basis goes up instead of down."*
> AARON LEVIE · @LEVIE · 12:44AM EDT · POST

Early tools could only be "wrappers," he wrote, but agents that run "for hours or days," coordinated swarms, domain-specific data and real workflow change make specialization more likely. He named security, life sciences, healthcare, finance and manufacturing.

III · MODELS AND TOOLS

Muse climbs a leaderboard; agents get crash-proof plumbing

Meta's top model entered a web-coding ranking, Vercel open-sourced the runtime behind v0, and two new agents went live.

#6	1,068	1M
Muse Wonder Full's debut rank in Code Arena: WebDev, 1,726 points	Tokens per second Inception reports for Mercury 3	Token context window on Mercury 3 and Muse Wonder

Alexandr Wang @alexandr_wang · chief AI officer, Meta

The LMArena leaderboard reported that Muse Wonder Full (Max) debuted at sixth overall in its WebDev coding arena, 75 points and 11 places above Muse Wonder (Max), "putting Meta in the top 3 labs." Wang was measured:

> *"muse wonder full on webdev arena. not bad, but clearly lots of room for us to improve!"*
> ALEXANDR WANG · @ALEXANDR_WANG · 12:18PM EDT · POST

Meta launched both models Oct. 12: Muse Wonder through its model API at $4 per million input tokens and $20 per million output tokens, and Wonder Full only to Muse Code subscribers on higher plans. Later Wang quote-posted a chart attributed to Deutsche Bank showing Muse "significantly ahead" of ChatGPT in downloads and daily active users 36 days after launch, with "this is what we in the business call framemogging." To a happy user he wrote, "muse will only get better as we keep going."

Guillermo Rauch @rauchg · CEO, Vercel

At 2:18pm EDT Rauch released the plumbing behind Vercel's v0 app builder:

> *"We open sourced a *really fast* HTML artifact builder. It's powered by libfx, making the agent durable. Building the low-level plumbing for v0 to survive server crashes, flaky LLMs, function limits was a huge pain. Now it's easy, free, and OSS"*
> GUILLERMO RAUCH · @RAUCHG · 2:18PM EDT · POST

Per the libfx documentation, each agent turn is saved step by step and resumes after a crash, redeploy or timeout, and every tool must declare whether it is safe to repeat. The demo "mini v0" draws on more than 200 models from Vercel's AI Gateway. Rauch also flagged Inception's diffusion model Mercury 3 on the gateway: "1,000 tokens per second btw." Inception's launch post says Mercury 3 generates tokens in parallel, offers a one-million-token context window and costs $0.10 per million input tokens.

QUICK HIT

Guillermo Rauch on MiniMax's M3.1 Flash, which Vercel's gateway is serving free through Oct. 22 for agentic, coding and cybersecurity work: "More free AI."

Tobi Lütke @tobi · CEO, Shopify

Replika founder Eugenia Kuyda released Wabi 2.0, an agent several people share in one thread that books, schedules and builds small apps for the group; TechCrunch reported it opened to all users Monday. Lütke: "This is extremely well crafted. You have to try it out."

Kanjun Qiu @kanjun · CEO, Imbue

Asked when someone would show new interaction designs built on language models, Qiu pointed to Imbue Studio, launched Oct. 1. Her example: "A todo list that automatically pulls from my email, slack, texts and generates UI to take the next step and let me review." She said Studio was inspired by the shared physical-computing lab Dynamicland, and that "The "physical" part isn't here yet, but I think over the next 5 years is possible."

IV · EUROPE AND THE SKY

Four carriers seek spectrum to answer Starlink

Europe's largest carriers want satellite-to-phone spectrum but no constellation of their own. Microsoft pitched sovereignty in Paris.

The telecom bid signed Monday

Deutsche Telekom, Orange, Telefónica and Vodafone signed a letter of intent to explore a joint bid for Europe's Mobile Satellite Services (MSS) spectrum, offering direct-to-device (D2D) service to all carriers. They would build ground infrastructure in Europe "without investing directly in a satellite constellation," which a partner "still to be selected" would provide. Musk answered the news only with a single emoji.

Via Satellite notes that SpaceX now owns EchoStar spectrum that is one of Europe's current MSS licenses, and that Deutsche Telekom was the first partner for SpaceX's second-generation Starlink Mobile. Ookla analyst Luke Kehoe told the outlet that Europe's operators "want to avoid becoming effectively MVNOs for satellite coverage," meaning resellers of someone else's network. Rapporteur reports the European Union (EU) aims to adopt its MSS rules by May 2027, with new licenses expected from 2028, and that the US ambassador to the EU has threatened retaliation if American companies are shut out.

Uncle Bob Martin @unclebobmartin · on Europe's other answer

Programmer Eric S. Raymond (@esrtweet) mocked a report that the EU is seeking fast-track antitrust approval for Project Bromo, the satellite venture of Airbus, Thales and Leonardo pitched as Europe's response to SpaceX. Martin replied at 10:13am EDT: "Meanwhile Elon will have a base and mass drivers on the Moon." To a skeptic he added, "betting against Elon Musk is unwise -- to be generous."

> QUICK HIT
> **Elon Musk**, at 9:02pm EDT, in a post that drew more than 116,000 likes: "Have to give the EU regulators credit where it's due for making all Apple products use USB-C." Later: "USB-C firmware is complex."

Satya Nadella @satyanadella · in Paris

At 5:21am EDT today Nadella announced "new capabilities across Microsoft Sovereign Cloud" in Paris. Microsoft's post lists a Sovereign Control Panel entering preview at Ignite; Data Guardian, which adds oversight by a trusted EU partner when Microsoft engineers remotely access EU and European Free Trade Association (EFTA) systems; general availability of customer-held root encryption keys; and, at Ignite, GitHub Enterprise Local and Foundry Local for customer-run sites, including disconnected ones. He also met Saint-Gobain, which is using Microsoft Discovery to develop more efficient construction materials.

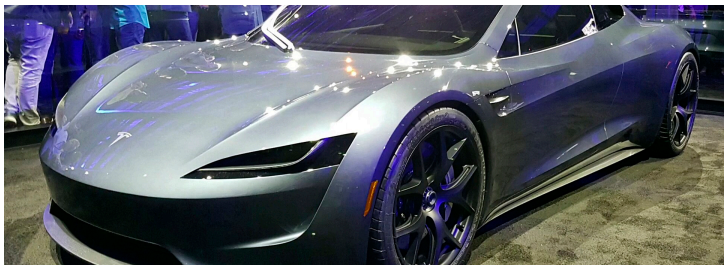
V · THE ROADSTER ARGUMENT

Carmack asks Grok; LeCun keeps doing the math

John Carmack ran the thruster car past an AI. Musk liked the answer. Yann LeCun spent Monday defending his skepticism, partly in French.

John Carmack @ID_AA_Carmack · founder, Keen Technologies

At 8:09pm EDT Carmack posted only "Silly shower thought:" with a shared Grok conversation titled "Tesla Roadster Cold Gas Thruster Track Performance Benefit." The car Tesla showed last Thursday uses compressed-air thrusters to lift, flip and land, and Car and Driver's explainer details the fan suction that holds it to the track. Musk answered at 1:08am EDT: "Grok's engineering analysis is good."



The second-generation Tesla Roadster prototype at its unveiling in November 2017.

PHOTO: SMNT · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS (CROPPED)

Yann LeCun @ylecun · AI scientist and founder

In replies tagging electric-vehicle reporter Fred Lambert, LeCun fielded a stream of challenges. To one who said the control system works and propulsion can be improved, he wrote "No they can't. That's the point." To one who claimed he used the wrong unit for specific impulse: "Seconds. Which is what I used." To one who compared the demo to the Wright brothers' 120-foot first flight, he noted that a steam-powered plane had flown about 50 meters in 1890 but could not be controlled, "which is why you never heard about it. It was a technological dead end." Called a "loser" in French, he answered in French:

> *"My whole career is built on the dream of being able to build things seen as impossible. And I am continuing by creating a company (at the young age of 66) to bring the next AI revolution. So no, I have not stopped dreaming … But my technical-bullshit detector is sharp enough that I must point out to the dazzled public the limitations of superficially cool demos."*
>
> YANN LECUN · @YLECUN · 11:01AM EDT · TRANSLATED FROM FRENCH · POST

Told he has not seen current Full Self-Driving (FSD), he replied "I have a 2023 Model S Plaid with FSD," and he reminded another reply that "ConvNets are also used in Tesla's FSD." His summary of the weekend: "Trolling Elon is a kind of weekend hobby."

VI · FIELD NOTES

Hangzhou, Shanghai and a new X timeline

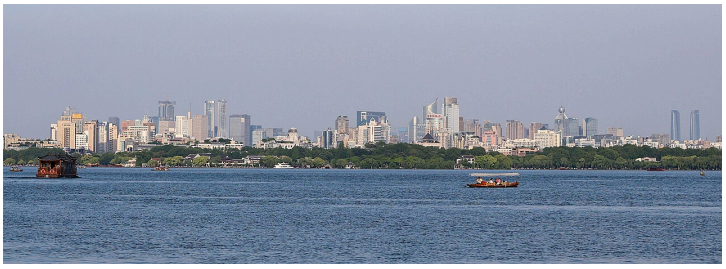
Heinemeier Hansson rode in a Mercedes and missed Chinese EVs; Sweeney landed for UnrealFest; Musk retuned the feed.

David Heinemeier Hansson @dhh · in Hangzhou

A day after praising a Chinese car's interior in Shenzhen, he reported from Hangzhou at 9:34am EDT:

> *"We got picked up in an actual Mercedes at the airport here in Hangzhou. It was gas powered too. Felt like a significant step down from the luxury Chinese EVs I had been in the last few days. Didn't know it was this bad. Damn."*
>
> DAVID HEINEMEIER HANSSON · @DHH · 9:34AM EDT · POST

Asked whether he would trade his Tesla Roadster reservation for a Xiaomi, he answered "Tesla is the only Western car company that feels well prepared to meet the Chinese competition. But I am visiting Xiaomi later on this trip!" He said he was in town "to meet new friends at Alibaba Cloud," hoped to "work with Huawei to make it possible to install Omarchy on this glorious hardware," and asked a Chinese user who wants better Omarchy fonts to "send a PR." His most-liked post of the day was two sentences: "You have to invent the future. It doesn't just happen."



Hangzhou's skyline across West Lake, April 2026.

PHOTO: WINDMEMORIES · CC BY-SA 4.0 VIA WIKIMEDIA COMMONS

Tim Sweeney @TimSweeneyEpic · in Shanghai

"Hello from Shanghai, where I'll be presenting at UnrealFest later this week. And two weeks later, UnrealFest Tokyo," he wrote at 8:38pm EDT. Earlier he dismissed posts claiming that Anthropic's Claude had suggested brand collaborations, including one with Harry Potter: "They linked to a paywalled Bloomberg article nobody would read and then made up a bunch of wild quote in the thread and reported them as fact." Replying to Second Life founder Philip Rosedale on how minds are structured, he wrote that "the fact that we can have a high quality generative image model in the same space as 1000 photos says there is far more regularity than anyone imagined."

Elon Musk @elonmusk · on the X feed

At 10:41pm EDT Musk described changes to how X picks posts:

> *"Two important changes to timeline recommendations: - New AI/SI ranking model that predicts probable time spent much better - Retrieval model trained to surface posts people read all the way through. User active seconds is growing exponentially and hitting all-time highs almost every day"*
>
> **ELON MUSK · @ELONMUSK · 10:41PM EDT · POST**

He added after midnight, "Rewriting the X Android app was also a big deal. It was really bad for such a long time." He also reposted The Boring Company's freight test: a Prufrock tunnel truck built on Tesla Model 3 batteries and drive units, modified to carry a standard 20-foot shipping container.

> **QUICK HIT**
>
> **Paul Graham** (@paulg): "Someone asked what was the best way to get hired by a startup. I told him it was to start one and then hire himself."

François Chollet (@fchollet), the Keras creator, offered a line for a week of pledges and promises: "When enough people believe something will happen, it doesn't need to happen at all for all of its consequences to be felt."

Also on the wire

Michael Dell. Thanking Jensen Huang over the weekend, Dell recalled his first trip to Taiwan in 1985, at 20, when Compeq made his circuit boards, and showed the hand-wired prototype of his first 286-based PC. Monday he added a footnote: "TSMC was founded in 1987."

Tim Sweeney on compilers. When researcher Victor Taelin imagined a compiler that swaps in "provably equivalent" faster algorithms, Sweeney said provability "is critical here. Otherwise it's adding massive risk and uncertainty which ought not happen at compile time," fixing a typo in a follow-up.

Tim Sweeney on screens. Shown a 2004 photo of himself and Gabe Newell at 30-inch Apple displays, he recalled that "All Unreal Engine 1 development was on analog monitors that were far from pixel perfect," and said he now uses "the new Dell 5K 120Hz."

Uncle Bob Martin. After a user said Amazon forbids using bots with it and strips information from receipts, Martin wrote "The @bot wars are heating up fast."

Guillermo Rauch. He congratulated Rebill, which raised $5.4 million to build financial infrastructure for the Americas with Rauch and SpaceX executives among its backers: "Congrats!"

Paul Graham. To cardiologist Eric Topol's chart of rising US heart-disease deaths, he asked, "How much of this is because fewer people are dying of cancer?" He also advised hanging paintings so "the light on them is coming from the same direction as the light in them."

Jim Fan. The Nvidia research director answered a post arguing that robot "skills" written as testable code suit factories, where "an 86% task completion rate is unacceptable," with "Best of both worlds!"

Alexandr Wang. On a New Yorker cartoon recast as a Muse meme: "achievement unlocked: new yorker cartoon has become a muse meme account."

Takeaways

1. President Trump said Musk's one-share-per-child SpaceX gift will flow through Trump Accounts; Michael Dell and Joe Gebbia cheered, and share class and custody remain open.
2. Microsoft expanded Project Perception with Guardian Agents and risk scoring, on Satya Nadella's premise that frontier models should be trusted least.
3. Builders put agents on real chores: nightly Omarchy QA, twice-as-fast bug tracing at Epic, and code-cleanliness gates.
4. Muse Wonder Full entered WebDev Arena at sixth; Vercel open-sourced libfx; Mercury 3 and Wabi 2.0 went live.
5. Deutsche Telekom, Orange, Telefónica and Vodafone will explore a joint satellite-spectrum bid without building a constellation.
6. SpaceX reports Q3 results after today's close (webcast 4:30pm EDT); Tesla follows Wednesday at 5:30pm EDT.

On the beat

POSTED · 17

Elon Musk, Uncle Bob Martin, Yann LeCun, David Heinemeier Hansson, Tim Sweeney, Guillermo Rauch, Alexandr Wang, Michael Dell, Satya Nadella, Tobi Lütke, Paul Graham, Kanjun Qiu, Aaron Levie, John Carmack, François Chollet, Joe Gebbia, Jim Fan.

SILENT · 29

Marc Andreessen, Jensen Huang, Ashok Elluswamy, Andrej Karpathy, Sam Altman, Demis Hassabis, Dario Amodei, Patrick Collison, Palmer Luckey, Vitalik Buterin, Jeff Dean, Fei-Fei Li, Greg Brockman, Mustafa Suleyman, Andrew Ng, Michael Truell, Tom Brown, Clément Delangue, Mira Murati, Mark Zuckerberg, Noam Brown, David Singleton, Ilya Sutskever, Lisa Su, Sundar Pichai, Nat Friedman, Arthur Mensch, Guillaume Lample, Mark Chen.

The watch list stands at 46.

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